

### Two Products, Separate Surfaces to Verify

Claude Code is an interactive development product. Claude Agent SDK supports integrations or applications that call Claude. Their exact relationship depends on the version and surface published by Anthropic; do not infer a shared architecture from a similar interface.

| Surface       | Check before deciding                                       |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| IDE extension | Editor documentation and official product page              |
| SDK           | API reference, supported versions, and permission model     |
| MCP           | Server, exposed tools, transport, and requested permissions |

### MCP and IDE Integration

MCP is a tooling protocol. An integration can use MCP, an SDK, a native extension, or several of these mechanisms. None should be presented as a required condition for another.

IDE or local service ↔ published integration ↔ authorized tools

The security decision is unchanged: identify the tools actually exposed, their scope, and the execution path before granting permission.

### MCP Vetting Before Installation

```
# 1. Check the maintainer, repository, and targeted release  gh repo view <
mcp-repo > # 2. Check the version (never use "latest")
# Always pin: @1.2.3 not @latest
# 3. Read tools and permissions, then scan if available  npx
mcp-scan ./skill-directory
```

Do not use stars or a ranking as security evidence. Never approve an MCP from an unknown source without checking its tools, permissions, version, and update mechanism.

### Custom Agent SDK use cases

The Agent SDK can support integrations beyond standard IDEs: CI, PR analysis, dashboards, or review systems. Check the current API and limits in official documentation before designing the integration. See also [Agent Tools](#) and the [glossary](#).